

KALE REALTY

2.82%.

Buyer agent commissions are higher now than before the settlement.

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**THE SETTLEMENT
WAS SUPPOSED TO
CUT WHAT BUYERS
PAY THEIR AGENT.**

Two years later, the number went up.

THE AGENTS WHO CUT THEIR RATE TO SURVIVE GAVE UP MONEY NOBODY WAS TAKING FROM THEM.

Average buyer agent commission dropped to 2.58% right after the settlement, then climbed back past where it started, to 2.82% by February 2026 (Clever Real Estate's national survey of 533 agents). The agents who assumed clients would only accept a discount preemptively lowered their own fee. The agents who kept explaining what they actually do, and what it's worth, are the ones getting paid the higher number two years later.

THE VALUE CONVERSATION THAT REPLACES THE DISCOUNT:

- 1 Say your fee out loud, early.**
Waiting for the buyer to ask makes it feel negotiable before you've said what it buys them.
- 2 Name what the fee pays for.**
Contract negotiation, inspection management, appraisal gap coverage, being reachable at every step. Specific, not general.
- 3 Don't discount before anyone asks you to.**
If a buyer never brought up the settlement, the settlement isn't the reason to lower your number.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE PAPERWORK CHANGED. THE VALUE CONVERSATION DIDN'T.

Have it before they ask.